



# Variables & the Environment

*"An idiot admires complexity, a genius admires simplicity" – Terry Davis*

Hans-Kristian Erik Östlund

Date: 2026.06.11

Pre-Req: Scala Environment & git (if possible)

# Contents

- ❑ **Overview** -> General understanding of the learning goals
- ❑ **PART 1** -> Core concepts and understanding (*15/20 min*)
  - ❑ Inference Rules Review -> Very quick
  - ❑ Interpreters & Programs -> Lettuce Programming Language
  - ❑ Lettuce Lets
  - ❑ Scala Vals
  - ❑ Lets w/ Inference
- ❑ **PART 2** -> Progressive exercises (*20/25 min*)
  - ❑ Focus on implementing a basic lettuce language

When a program uses a variable,  
how does the interpreter know what  
value that variable holds?

# Part 1

# Inference Rules

# Inference Rules - Background

## ❑ “Inference Rules” extension of Discrete Mathematics

❑ Propositional logic + Rules of Inference

## ❑ We shall apply logical principles to establish theorems and validate algorithms

❑ These help establish “automated reasoning”

### Rules of Inference

Modus Ponens  $\frac{p \rightarrow q, p}{\therefore q}$

Modus Tollens  $\frac{p \rightarrow q, \neg q}{\therefore \neg p}$

Hypothetical Syllogism  $\frac{p \rightarrow q, q \rightarrow r}{\therefore p \rightarrow r}$

Disjunctive Syllogism  $\frac{p \vee q, \neg p}{\therefore q}$

Addition  $\frac{p}{\therefore p \vee q}$

Simplification  $\frac{p \wedge q}{\therefore p}$

Conjunction  $\frac{p, q}{\therefore p \wedge q}$

Resolution  $\frac{p \vee q, \neg p \vee r}{\therefore q \vee r}$

# Inference Rules - Notation

Inference Rules Structure

$$\frac{\text{premise}_1, \dots, \text{premise}_n}{\therefore (\text{statement} =) \text{conclusion}} \text{rule-name} \quad n \in \mathbb{Z}^+$$

- ❑ Describe relation between a set of judgements
- ❑ **Axiom:** Statement accepted as true without proof (no premises)
  - ❑ How do we read this?

# Inference Rules - Example (Delete)

## ❑ Delete first instance of $n$ in list

- ❑ Linked List:  $L$
- ❑ Number:  $n$

## ❑ State Assumptions clearly

- ❑ Algorithmic design of:
  - ❑ Value is not in the list?
  - ❑ Is the list ordered?

## ❑ Judgement form: $l \text{ delete } n = v$

## ❑ Concrete Syntax: Data looks like

Concrete Syntax

$$\begin{array}{l} \text{var} \Rightarrow \text{list} \\ | \text{ ERROR} \end{array}$$
$$\begin{array}{l} \text{list} \Rightarrow X \\ | n \rightarrow \text{list} \end{array}$$
$$n \in \mathbb{N}$$



# Inference Rules - Example (Delete)

|                 |
|-----------------|
| Inference Rules |
|-----------------|

$$\frac{}{X \text{ delete } n = ERROR} \text{empty-no-delete}$$

$$\frac{n_1 = n_2}{n_1 \rightarrow list \text{ delete } n_2 = list} \text{non-empty-delete}$$

$$\frac{n_1 \neq n_2, \quad list_{new} = list \text{ delete } n_2}{n_1 \rightarrow list \text{ delete } n_2 = n_1 \rightarrow list_{new}} \text{non-empty-tail}$$

□ (Explicit vs. Implicit) & Consolidation

# Inference Rules - Example (Delete)

## ❑ Using these Operational Semantics

❑ Assume - 1:  $5 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow X$

❑ Derivation of the list:

❑ 1

❑  $\Rightarrow n \rightarrow 1$

❑  $\Rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 1$

❑  $\Rightarrow 5 \rightarrow n \rightarrow 1$

❑  $\Rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 1$

❑  $\Rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow n \rightarrow 1$

❑  $\Rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow 1$

❑  $\Rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow X$

## ❑ Now delete 7 from the list

❑ Expect  $5 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow X$

Judgement Derivation

$$\frac{\frac{7 = 7}{5 \neq 7 \quad 7 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow X \text{ delete } 7 = 10 \rightarrow X} \text{non-empty-delete}}{5 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow X \text{ delete } 7 = 5 \rightarrow 10 \rightarrow X} \text{non-empty-tail}$$

# Inference Rules - Example (Delete)

match

case object  
case class

sealed trait

## Inference Rules - Example (Delete)

```
5 case object Empty extends List
4 case class Node(n1: Int, tail: List) extends List
3
2 sealed trait List {
1   def delete(n2: Int): List = {
155   this match {
1     case Empty => throw new Exception
2     case Node(n1, tail) => {
3       if (n1 == n2)
4         tail
5       else
6         Node(n1, tail.delete(n2))
7     }
8   }
9 }
10 }
```

# Interpreters & Programs

If we have an expression (e), and values (v), how is this handled?

**Big-Step / Natural --- `eval(1 + 2 * 3) = 7`**

# Scala Vals

# Scala Vals - Expected Values - Scala: Res#: Int = \_

```
13 1
12
11 1 + 2
10
9 1 + (2 / 2)
```

```
7 {
6     def f(n: Int): Int = n * 2
5     f(22) // 44
4 } + {
3     def g(n: Int): Int = n / 5
2     g(100) // 20
1 }
```

```
1 x
2
3 val x = 1
4 x
5
6 val x = 1 + 2 / 2
7 x
8
9 val x = 1 + 1
10 x
```



# Scala Vals - Expected Values - Scala: Res#: Int = \_

```
13 1
12
11 1 + 2
10
9 1 + (2 / 2)
```

1  
3  
2

```
7 {
6     def f(n: Int): Int = n * 2
5     f(22) // 44
4 } + {
3     def g(n: Int): Int = n / 5
2     g(100) // 20
1 }
```

64

```
1 x
2
3 val x = 1
4 x
5
6 val x = 1 + 2 / 2
7 x
8
9 val x = 1 + 1
10 x
```

Err  
1  
2  
2

# Scala Vals - Expected Values - Scala: Res#: Int = \_

```
13 1
12
11 1 + 2
10
9 1 + (2 / 2)
```

1

3

2

```
10 val x = 2
9 x
8
7 2
```

```
7 {
6   def f(n: Int): Int = n * 2
5   f(22) // 44
4 } + {
3   def g(n: Int): Int = n / 5
2   g(100) // 20
1 }
```

64

```
5 val x = {
4   val y = 2
3   y + 1
2 }
1 x
```

```
1 x
2
3 val x = 1
4 x
5
6 val x = 1 + 2 / 2
7 x
8
9 val x = 1 + 1
10 x
```

Err

1

2

2

```
1 val x = {
2   val y = 2
3   y + 1
4 }
5 x + y
```

# Scala Vals - Expected Values - Scala: Res#: Int = \_

```
13 1
12
11 1 + 2
10
9 1 + (2 / 2)
```

1

3

2

```
10 val x = 2
9 x
8
7 2
```

2

2

```
7 {
6   def f(n: Int): Int = n * 2
5   f(22) // 44
4 } + {
3   def g(n: Int): Int = n / 5
2   g(100) // 20
1 }
```

64

```
5 val x = {
4   val y = 2
3   y + 1
2 }
1 x
```

3

```
1 x
2
3 val x = 1
4 x
5
6 val x = 1 + 2 / 2
7 x
8
9 val x = 1 + 1
10 x
```

Err

1

2

2

```
1 val x = {
2   val y = 2
3   y + 1
4 }
5 x + y
```

Err

# Scala Vals - Expected Values - Scala: Res#: Int = \_

```
13 1
12
11 1 + 2
10
9 1 + (2 / 2)
```

1

3

2

```
7 {
6   def f(n: Int): Int = n * 2
5   f(22) // 44
4 } + {
3   def g(n: Int): Int = n / 5
2   g(100) // 20
1 }
```

64

```
1 x
2
3 val x = 1
4 x
5
6 val x = 1 + 2 / 2
7 x
8
9 val x = 1 + 1
10 x
```

Err

1

2

2

```
10 val x = 2
9 x
8
7 2
```

2

2

```
5 val x = {
4   val y = 2
3   y + 1
2 }
1 x
```

3

```
1 val x = {
2   val y = 2
3   y + 1
4 }
5 x + y
```

Err

```
7 val x = {
8   val x = 2
9   x + 1
10 }
11 x
```

```
3 val x = {
2   val x = x + 1
1   x + 1
217 }
1 x
```

```
3 val x = {
4   val x = {
5       val x = 1
6       x + 1
7   }
8   x + 1
9 }
10 x
```

# Scala Vals - Expected Values - Scala: Res#: Int = \_

```
13 1
12
11 1 + 2
10
9 1 + (2 / 2)
```

1

3

2

```
7 {
6   def f(n: Int): Int = n * 2
5   f(22) // 44
4 } + {
3   def g(n: Int): Int = n / 5
2   g(100) // 20
1 }
```

64

```
1 x
2
3 val x = 1
4 x
5
6 val x = 1 + 2 / 2
7 x
8
9 val x = 1 + 1
10 x
```

Err

1

2

2

```
10 val x = 2
9 x
8
7 2
```

2

2

```
5 val x = {
4   val y = 2
3   y + 1
2 }
1 x
```

3

```
1 val x = {
2   val y = 2
3   y + 1
4 }
5 x + y
```

Err

```
7 val x = {
8   val x = 2
9   x + 1
10 }
11 x
```

3

```
3 val x = {
2   val x = x + 1
1   x + 1
217 }
1 x
```

Err

```
3 val x = {
4   val x = {
5       val x = 1
6       x + 1
7   }
8   x + 1
9 }
10 x
```

3

# Lettuce Lets

# Lettuce Lets - Programming Language

## ❑ We want our own Interpreter

- ❑ Similar to OCaml
- ❑ Defining language of the program
  - ❑ Inductive logic in grammars for concrete syntax
- ❑ Defining semantics in the language
  - ❑ Inductive logic as inference rules
- ❑ Using Scala, JVM, ...
  - ❑ Rewrite the grammar as abstract syntax
  - ❑ Code class Hierarchy
  - ❑ Code evaluation methods
  - ❑ Any necessary helpers

### Example OCaml Code

```
1 let rec delete n lst =  
2   match lst with  
3   | []      -> [] (* delete-empty *)  
4   | hd :: tl ->  
5       if hd = n then tl (* delete-head *)  
6       else hd :: delete n tl (* delete-tail *)  
7  
8 let numbers = [1; 2; 3; 4; 3; 5]  
9 let result = delete 3 numbers  
10 (* result = [1; 2; 4; 3; 5] *)
```

# Lettuce Lets - Language

## Sample Lettuce Concrete Syntax

$e \Rightarrow v$

- |  $e_1 + e_2$                       we can add multiple expressions
- |  $e_1 / e_2$                         we can divide multiple expressions
- |  $let\ id = e_1\ in\ e_2$         we can initialize variables
- |  $id$                                 we can use variables
- |  $(e)$

$v \Rightarrow n$

| *ERROR*

$n$  is a number

$id$  is a variable identifier e.g.  $x$



# Lettuce Lets - Similar Expected Value

```
9 let x =.  
8   let x =.  
7     let x = 1.  
6     in  
5       x + 1  
4   in  
3     x + 1.  
2 in  
1 x
```

```
1 let x =.  
2   let y = 1 + 2/2.  
3   in  
4     y + 1.  
5 in  
6 x
```

$$e \Rightarrow v$$

- |  $e_1 + e_2$
- |  $e_1 / e_2$
- |  $\text{let } id = e_1 \text{ in } e_2$
- |  $id$
- |  $(e)$

$$v \Rightarrow n$$

- | *ERROR*

Our interpreter must know value of variables at each point in time => environment => Map[K,V]

**Lets w/ Inference**

# Lets w/ Inference - Value Domain (old)

Value Inference Rule

$$\frac{v \in \mathbb{N}}{eval(v) = v} \text{num-ok}$$

## ❑ Totally valid

- ❑ But what are some issues?
- ❑ Implementation?

Sample Lettuce Concrete Syntax

$$e \Rightarrow v$$

- |  $e_1 + e_2$
- |  $e_1 / e_2$
- |  $let\ id = e_1\ in\ e_2$
- |  $id$
- |  $(e)$

$$v \Rightarrow n$$

- |  $ERROR$

## Lets w/ Inference - Value Domain (old)

```
1 sealed trait Expr {  
2     def eval: Value = this match {  
3         case N(n) => N(n)  
4         case _   => ???  
5     }  
6 }  
7 sealed trait Value extends Expr  
8 case class N(n: Double) extends Value  
9
```

## Lets w/ Inference - Value Domain (new)

Value Inference Rule (Rest of Class)

$$\frac{}{eval(Const(n)) = n} \text{const-ok}$$

- ❑ Allows us to de-couple for method implementations
  - ❑ Notice: Value is no longer an extension of an expression

## Lets w/ Inference - Value Domain (new)

```
1 sealed trait Expr {  
2     def eval: Value = this match {  
3         case Const(n) => NumValue(n)  
4         case _ => ???  
5     }  
6 }  
7 case class Const(f: Double) extends Expr  
8  
9 sealed trait Value  
10 case class NumValue(n: Double) extends Value
```

# Part 2

GitHub Repo



Lets w/ Inference - Plus (e1 + e2)

$eval( Plus( e_1, e_2 ) ) =$

plus-ok

Lets w/ Inference - Plus (e1 + e2) - Now Implement!

$$\frac{eval(e_1) = v_1, \quad v_1 \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad eval(e_2) = v_2, \quad v_2 \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad v_1 + v_2 = v_{res}}{eval( Plus( e_1, e_2 ) ) = v_{res}} \text{plus-ok}$$

Lets w/ Inference - Gt (e1 > e2)

$eval( Gt( e_1, e_2 ) ) =$

gt-ok

Lets w/ Inference - Gt (e1 > e2) - Now Implement!

$$\frac{eval(e_1) = v_1, \quad v_1 \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad eval(e_2) = v_2, \quad v_2 \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad v_1 > v_2 = v_{res}}{eval( Gt( e_1, e_2 ) ) = v_{res}}_{\text{gt-ok}}$$

## Lets w/ Inference - Errors?

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{e_1}}}{eval( Plus( e_1, e_2 ) ) = \boxed{\phantom{e_2}}} \text{plus-error-1}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{e_1}}}{eval( Gt( e_1, e_2 ) ) = \boxed{\phantom{e_2}}} \text{gt-error-1}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{e_1}}}{eval( Plus( e_1, e_2 ) ) = \boxed{\phantom{e_2}}} \text{plus-error-2}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{e_1}}}{eval( Gt( e_1, e_2 ) ) = \boxed{\phantom{e_2}}} \text{gt-error-2}$$

## Lets w/ Inference - Errors? - Now Implement!

$$\frac{eval(e_1) = v_1, \quad v_1 \notin \mathbb{Z}}{eval( Plus( e_1, e_2 ) ) = ERROR} \text{plus-error-1}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1) = v_1, \quad v_1 \notin \mathbb{Z}}{eval( Gt( e_1, e_2 ) ) = ERROR} \text{gt-error-1}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1) = v_1, \quad v_1 \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad eval(e_2) = v_2, \quad v_2 \notin \mathbb{Z}}{eval( Plus( e_1, e_2 ) ) = ERROR} \text{plus-error-2}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1) = v_1, \quad v_1 \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad eval(e_2) = v_2, \quad v_2 \notin \mathbb{Z}}{eval( Gt( e_1, e_2 ) ) = ERROR} \text{gt-error-2}$$

Lets w/ Inference - Errors? - Now Implement!

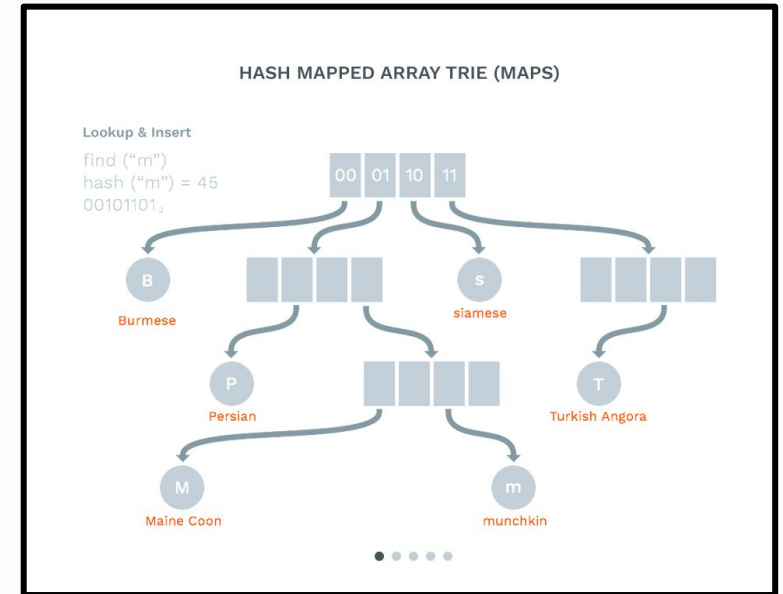
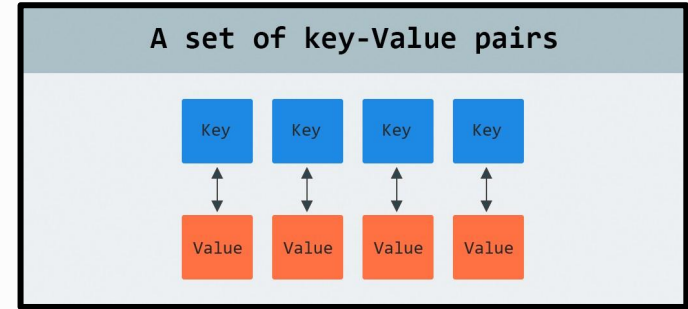
**Lettuce does not  
allow Implicit Type  
Conversions**

# Lets w/ Inference - Scala Map[K,V]

Python: Dict

- ❑ **Create:** `Map()` / `Map("x" -> 1.0)`
- ❑ **Update:** `m + (key -> value)`
- ❑ **Lookup:** `m(key)` (throws `absent`)
- ❑ **Check Presence:** `m.contains(key)`
- ❑ **Safe Lookup:** `m.get(key)`

- ❑ **At the end of the day**
  - ❑ We can store variables for our interpreter





## Lets w/ Inference - Scala Map[K,V]

```
11 val m0: Map[String, Double] = Map()
10 val b0: Boolean = m0 contains "x"
9
8 val m0: Map[String, Double] = Map()
7 val m1 = m0 + ("x" -> 3155.0)
6 val m2 = m1 + ("y" -> 2270.0) + ("z" -> 1300.0)
5
4 if (m2.contains("y")) {
3     val y = m2("y")
2     println(s"FOUND y: $y")
1 }
161
1 // works for other types
2 val m: Map[Int, String] = Map((2270 -> "Data Structures"), (3155 -> "PPL"))
3
4 val k = 3155
5 if (m contains k) {
6     val v = m(k)
7     println(s"FOUND $k: $v")
8 }
```

# Lets w/ Inference - Our Interpreter

Our expression handling goal -  $\text{eval}(e, \text{env}) = v$

```
8 ~~~
7 let x =
6   let x = x + 1.
5   in
4   x + 1.
3 in
2 x
1 ~~~
179 █
1 ~~~
2 let x = 1 + 1 in
3   let y = 2 + 2 in
4       x + y
5 ~~~
```

Lets w/ Inference - Our Interpreter - Now Implement!

```
2 type Environment = Map[String, Value]
```

# Lets w/ Inference - id and let id = e1 in e2?

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{error}}}}{\text{eval}(\text{Ident}(id), env) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{error}}}} \text{ (ident-error)}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{env}}}}{\text{eval}(\text{Ident}(id), env) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{env}}}} \text{ (ident-ok)}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{error}}}}{\text{eval}(\text{Let}(id, e_1, e_2), env) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{error}}}} \text{ (let-error)}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{env}}}}{\text{eval}(\text{Let}(id, e_1, e_2), env) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{env}}}} \text{ (let-ok)}$$

# Lets w/ Inference - id and let id = e1 in e2? - Impl!

$$\frac{id \notin env}{eval(Ident(id), env) = ERROR} \text{ (ident-error)}$$

$$\frac{id \in env, \quad env(id) = v}{eval(Ident(id), env) = v} \text{ (ident-ok)}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1, env) = ERROR}{eval(Let(id, e_1, e_2), env) = ERROR} \text{ (let-error)}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1, env) = v_1, \quad v_1 \neq ERROR, \quad env \circ \{id \mapsto v_1\} = env_{new}, \quad eval(e_2, env_{new}) = v_2}{eval(Let(id, e_1, e_2), env) = v_2} \text{ (let-ok)}$$

## Lets w/ Inference - if (e1) e2 else e3

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{e_{ifTrue}}}}{eval(IfThenElse(e_{condition}, e_{ifTrue}, e_{ifFalse}), env) = \boxed{\phantom{e_{ifTrue}}} \text{ (if-error)}}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{e_{ifTrue}}}}{eval(IfThenElse(e_{condition}, e_{ifTrue}, e_{ifFalse}), env) = \boxed{\phantom{e_{ifTrue}}} \text{ (if-true)}}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{e_{ifTrue}}}}{eval(IfThenElse(e_{condition}, e_{ifTrue}, e_{ifFalse}), env) = \boxed{\phantom{e_{ifTrue}}} \text{ (if-false)}}$$

Lets w/ Inference - if (e1) e2 else e3 - Impl!

$$\frac{eval(e_{condition}, env) = v_1, \quad v_1 \notin \{true, false\}}{eval( IfThenElse( e_{condition}, e_{ifTrue}, e_{ifFalse} ), env ) = ERROR} \text{ (if-error)}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_{condition}, env) = true, \quad eval(e_{ifTrue}, env) = v_{ifTrue}}{eval( IfThenElse( e_{condition}, e_{ifTrue}, e_{ifFalse} ), env ) = v_{ifTrue}} \text{ (if-true)}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_{condition}, env) = false, \quad eval(e_{ifFalse}, env) = v_{ifFalse}}{eval( IfThenElse( e_{condition}, e_{ifTrue}, e_{ifFalse} ), env ) = v_{ifFalse}} \text{ (if-false)}$$

## Lets w/ Inference - e1 && e2

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}}{\text{eval}( \text{And}( e_1, e_2 ), \text{env} ) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}} \text{ (and-error-1)}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}}{\text{eval}( \text{And}( e_1, e_2 ), \text{env} ) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}} \text{ (and-false-short-circuit)}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}}{\text{eval}( \text{And}( e_1, e_2 ), \text{env} ) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}} \text{ (and-error-2)}$$

$$\frac{\boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}}{\text{eval}( \text{And}( e_1, e_2 ), \text{env} ) = \boxed{\phantom{\text{code}}}} \text{ (and-true)}$$

### ❑ Short Circuiting

- ❑ Truth Table of & (TT/TF/FT/FF)
- ❑  $F \& x = F$ ,  $T \& x = x$
- ❑ Avoid looking at x, if don't have to

- ❑ Lettuce: only allow BoolValue on && / And(e1, e2)



## Lets w/ Inference - e1 && e2 - Impl!

$$\frac{eval(e_1, env) = v_1, \quad v_1 \notin \{true, false\}}{eval( And( e_1, e_2 ), env ) = ERROR} \text{ (and-error-1)}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1, env) = false}{eval( And( e_1, e_2 ), env ) = false} \text{ (and-false-short-circuit)}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1, env) = true, \quad eval(e_2, env) = v_2, \quad v_2 \notin \{true, false\}}{eval( And( e_1, e_2 ), env ) = ERROR} \text{ (and-error-2)}$$

$$\frac{eval(e_1, env) = true, \quad eval(e_2, env) = v_2, \quad v_2 \in \{true, false\}}{eval( And( e_1, e_2 ), env ) = v_2} \text{ (and-true)}$$

# Functions

# Functions - Basic Understanding

```
let f=function(x)x+1 in  
f(5)  
⇒ 6
```

```
let g=function(y)function(z)y+z in  
g(5)(10)  
⇒ 15
```

```
let x=10 in  
let foo=function(y)x+y in  
let x=200 in  
foo(5)  
⇒ 15
```